

STA 2101: Statistics & Probability

Lecture 07: Variance & Standard Deviation

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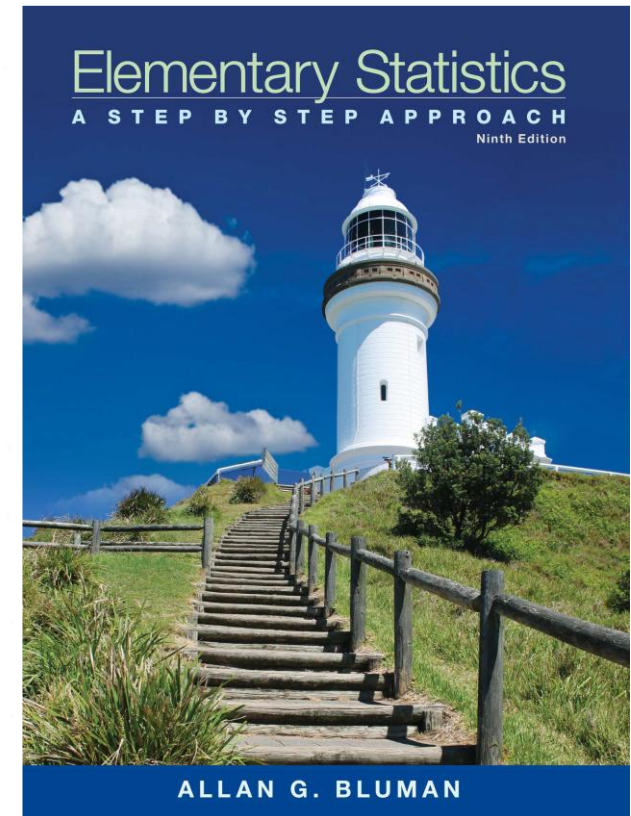
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Class Code
Sec 1 - es2uztok
Sec 5 - ayvzsvgm

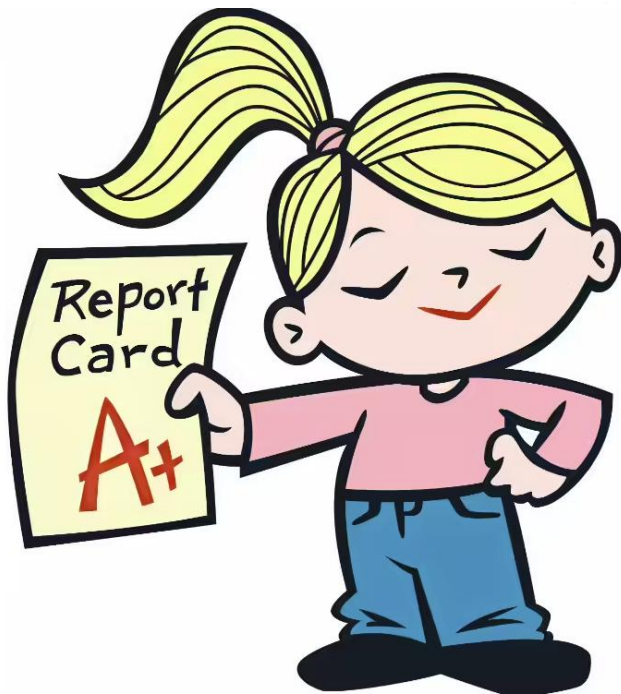
Spring 2026

Reference Book

- **Text Book(s):**
- Elementary Statistics – Allan G. Bluman
- Introduction to Probability and Statistics (14th Edition) By William Mendenhall, Robert J. Beaver, Barbara M. Beaver
- **Reference Material/Book(s):**
- S Introduction to probability and statistics for engineers and scientists, Sheldon M Ross



Mark Distribution



Assessments	%
Mid Term Examination	25
Final Examination	40
Attendance and Class Participation	5
CT	5
Project	25
Total	100

Today's Topics

- Variation
- Standard Deviation
- Cvar
- Chebyshev

EXAMPLE 3-20 Teacher Strikes

The number of public school teacher strikes in Pennsylvania for a random sample of school years is shown. Find the sample variance and the sample standard deviation.

9 10 14 7 8 3

Source: Pennsylvania School Board Association.

SOLUTION

Step 1 Find the mean of the data values.

$$\bar{X} = \frac{\sum X}{n} = \frac{9 + 10 + 14 + 7 + 8 + 3}{6} = \frac{51}{6} = 8.5$$

Step 2 Find the deviation for each data value ($X - \bar{X}$).

$$\begin{array}{lll} 9 - 8.5 = 0.5 & 10 - 8.5 = 1.5 & 14 - 8.5 = 5.5 \\ 7 - 8.5 = -1.5 & 8 - 8.5 = -0.5 & 3 - 8.5 = -5.5 \end{array}$$

Step 3 Square each of the deviations ($X - \bar{X}$)².

$$\begin{array}{lll} (0.5)^2 = 0.25 & (1.5)^2 = 2.25 & (5.5)^2 = 30.25 \\ (-1.5)^2 = 2.25 & (-0.5)^2 = 0.25 & (-5.5)^2 = 30.25 \end{array}$$

Step 4 Find the sum of the squares.

$$\sum (X - \bar{X})^2 = 0.25 + 2.25 + 30.25 + 2.25 + 0.25 + 30.25 = 65.5$$

Step 5 Divide by $n - 1$ to get the variance.

$$s^2 = \frac{\sum (X - \bar{X})^2}{n - 1} = \frac{65.5}{6 - 1} = \frac{65.5}{5} = 13.1$$

Step 6 Take the square root of the variance to get the standard deviation.

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum (X - \bar{X})^2}{n - 1}} = \sqrt{13.1} \approx 3.6 \text{ (rounded)}$$

Here the sample variance is 13.1, and the sample standard deviation is 3.6.

Variance and Standard Deviation for Grouped Data

Shortcut or Computational Formula for s^2 and s for Grouped Data

Sample variance:

$$s^2 = \frac{n(\sum f \cdot X_m^2) - (\sum f \cdot X_m)^2}{n(n - 1)}$$

Sample standard deviation

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{n(\sum f \cdot X_m^2) - (\sum f \cdot X_m)^2}{n(n - 1)}}$$

where X_m is the midpoint of each class and f is the frequency of each class.

EXAMPLE 3-22 Miles Run per Week

Find the sample variance and the sample standard deviation for the frequency distribution of the data in Example 2-7. The data represent the number of miles that 20 runners ran during one week.

Class	Frequency	Midpoint
5.5–10.5	1	8
10.5–15.5	2	13
15.5–20.5	3	18
20.5–25.5	5	23
25.5–30.5	4	28
30.5–35.5	3	33
35.5–40.5	2	38

SOLUTION

A Class	B Frequency	C Midpoint	D $f \cdot X_m$	E $f \cdot X_m^2$
5.5–10.5	1	8	8	64
10.5–15.5	2	13	26	338
15.5–20.5	3	18	54	972
20.5–25.5	5	23	115	2,645
25.5–30.5	4	28	112	3,136
30.5–35.5	3	33	99	3,267
35.5–40.5	2	38	76	2,888
	$n = 20$		$\Sigma f \cdot X_m = 490$	$\Sigma f \cdot X_m^2 = 13,310$

Substitute in the formula and solve for s^2 to get the variance.

$$\begin{aligned}
 s^2 &= \frac{n(\Sigma f \cdot X_m^2) - (\Sigma f \cdot X_m)^2}{n(n-1)} \\
 &= \frac{20(13,310) - 490^2}{20(20-1)} \\
 &= \frac{266,200 - 240,100}{20(19)} \\
 &= \frac{26,100}{380} \\
 &\approx 68.7
 \end{aligned}$$

Take the square root to get the standard deviation.

$$s \approx \sqrt{68.7} \approx 8.3$$

Coefficient of Variation

The **coefficient of variation**, denoted by CVar, is the standard deviation divided by the mean. The result is expressed as a percentage.

For samples,

$$\text{CVar} = \frac{s}{\bar{X}} \cdot 100$$

For populations,

$$\text{CVar} = \frac{\sigma}{\mu} \cdot 100$$

EXAMPLE 3-23 Sales of Automobiles

The mean of the number of sales of cars over a 3-month period is 87, and the standard deviation is 5. The mean of the commissions is \$5225, and the standard deviation is \$773. Compare the variations of the two.

SOLUTION

The coefficients of variation are

$$\text{CVar} = \frac{s}{\bar{X}} = \frac{5}{87} \cdot 100 = 5.7\% \quad \text{sales}$$

$$\text{CVar} = \frac{773}{5225} \cdot 100 = 14.8\% \quad \text{commissions}$$

Since the coefficient of variation is larger for commissions, the commissions are more variable than the sales.



EXAMPLE 3–24 Pages in Women's Fitness Magazines

The mean for the number of pages of a sample of women's fitness magazines is 132, with a variance of 23; the mean for the number of advertisements of a sample of women's fitness magazines is 182, with a variance of 62. Compare the variations.

SOLUTION

The coefficients of variation are

$$CV_{\text{ar}} = \frac{\sqrt{23}}{132} \cdot 100 = 3.6\% \quad \text{pages}$$

$$CV_{\text{ar}} = \frac{\sqrt{62}}{182} \cdot 100 = 4.3\% \quad \text{advertisements}$$

The number of advertisements is more variable than the number of pages since the coefficient of variation is larger for advertisements.

Range Rule of Thumb

The range can be used to approximate the standard deviation. The approximation is called the **range rule of thumb**.

The Range Rule of Thumb

A rough estimate of the standard deviation is

$$s \approx \frac{\text{range}}{4}$$

Chebyshev's Theorem

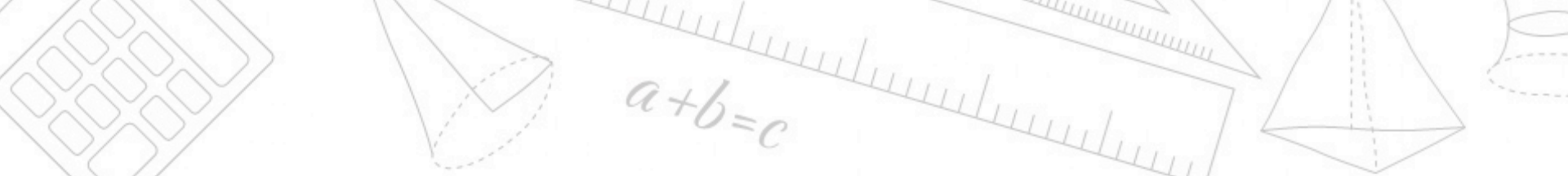
Chebyshev's theorem The proportion of values from a data set that will fall within k standard deviations of the mean will be at least $1 - 1/k^2$, where k is a number greater than 1 (k is not necessarily an integer).

This theorem states that at least three-fourths, or 75%, of the data values will fall within 2 standard deviations of the mean of the data set. This result is found by substituting $k = 2$ in the expression

$$1 - \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{or} \quad 1 - \frac{1}{2^2} = 1 - \frac{1}{4} = \frac{3}{4} = 75\%$$

Furthermore, the theorem states that at least eight-ninths, or 88.89%, of the data values will fall within 3 standard deviations of the mean. This result is found by letting $k = 3$ and substituting in the expression.

$$1 - \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{or} \quad 1 - \frac{1}{3^2} = 1 - \frac{1}{9} = \frac{8}{9} = 88.89\%$$



EXAMPLE 3–25 Prices of Homes

The mean price of houses in a certain neighborhood is \$50,000, and the standard deviation is \$10,000. Find the price range for which at least 75% of the houses will sell.

SOLUTION

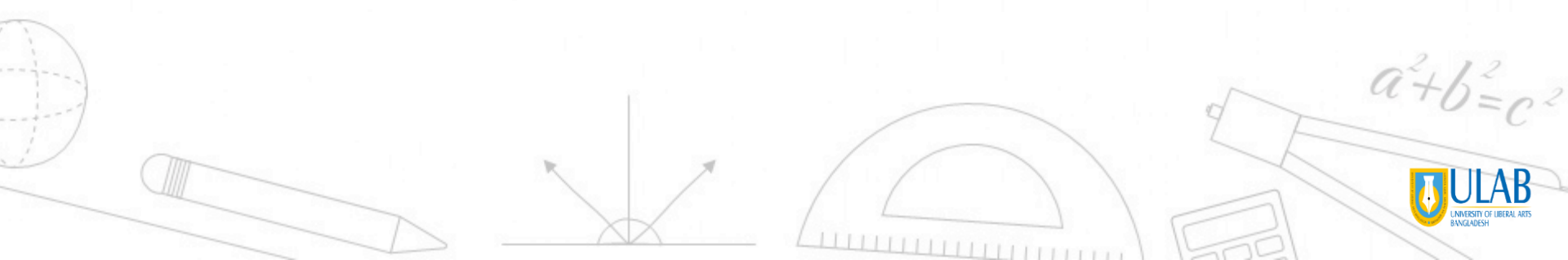
Chebyshev's theorem states that three-fourths, or 75%, of the data values will fall within 2 standard deviations of the mean. Thus,

$$\$50,000 + 2(\$10,000) = \$50,000 + \$20,000 = \$70,000$$

and

$$\$50,000 - 2(\$10,000) = \$50,000 - \$20,000 = \$30,000$$

Hence, at least 75% of all homes sold in the area will have a price range from \$30,000 to \$70,000.


$$a^2 + b^2 = c^2$$

EXAMPLE 3–26 Travel Allowances

A survey of local companies found that the mean amount of travel allowance for couriers was \$0.25 per mile. The standard deviation was \$0.02. Using Chebyshev's theorem, find the minimum percentage of the data values that will fall between \$0.20 and \$0.30.

SOLUTION

Step 1 Subtract the mean from the larger value.

$$\$0.30 - \$0.25 = \$0.05$$

Step 2 Divide the difference by the standard deviation to get k .

$$k = \frac{0.05}{0.02} = 2.5$$

Step 3 Use Chebyshev's theorem to find the percentage.

$$1 - \frac{1}{k^2} = 1 - \frac{1}{2.5^2} = 1 - \frac{1}{6.25} = 1 - 0.16 = 0.84 \quad \text{or} \quad 84\%$$

Hence, at least 84% of the data values will fall between \$0.20 and \$0.30.



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Thank You

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